

advanced release in the OpenSUSE Leap series. The engineers have equipped the platform with cutting-edge tools for cloud users. There are some built-in solutions to ease AWS image uploading and management.

This is not the first time OpenSUSE Leap has arrived on the cloud. A large number of AWS users were previously using the open source platform by installing the OpenSUSE OS images from the last few years. But the official addition to places such as AWS Marketplace has simplified its installation process. Moreover, users on AWS can now also run the Docker container with OpenSUSE cloud images in virtual machines.

Samsung's Tizen gets .NET support

Months after embracing Microsoft's .NET, Samsung has formally added support for the software framework to its Tizen platform. The new development is for Tizen 4.0, which will be released in September this year.

Samsung had brought out the first preview of .NET Core support and some new Visual Studio tools for Tizen last November. But now, the Korean giant is on the move to make developers familiar with .NET Standard and Xamarin.Forms. This is apparently aimed to expand the app ecosystem of the open source platform. "The first official version of Tizen .NET will be released in September 2017 as a part of Tizen 4.0. Until then, several previews or beta versions will be released in every two or three months so that developers can begin making themselves familiar with Tizen .NET and give early feedback," Samsung's developer team wrote in the official Tizen roadmap page.

The Tizen 4.0 public release with .NET support will be available for both ARM and x86 architectures. Though Microsoft's framework will initially bring new apps to Tizen-based smart TVs, the upcoming support would be expanded across wearables like Samsung Gear smartwatches and even smartphones, over time.

Some initial reports suggest that apart from the range of Samsung's hardware, Tizen will also make its presence felt on development boards such as Raspberry Pi and Artik. This is likely to boost the developer community's interest in Samsung's platform, when building their next apps.

Tizen is already competing against Android and iOS. But the addition of development board compatibility will make the platform a major rival of Android Things, which Google

recently launched to support IoT devices. Samsung is already giving away huge cash prizes to developers to attract them to its platform.

Apart from Samsung, Huawei, Intel, Panasonic and Vodafone are members of the Tizen Association. Interestingly, all these players are also supporting Microsoft in its major software developments.

LibreOffice 5.3 comes with online productivity

Expanding its presence in the productivity world, the Document Foundation has released LibreOffice 5.3. This new open source office suite is debuting on the private cloud while being available on Linux, iOS and Windows.

The very first change noticed on LibreOffice 5.3 is its online appearance. First announced last August, the latest LibreOffice version includes the first source release of LibreOffice Online. The new cloud office suite enables basic collaborative editing of documents right in your Web browser.

Fedora 26 to bring out GNOME 3.24 desktop environment

The Fedora project has released a features list of the upcoming Fedora 26. This new version will be shipped with the GNOME 3.24 desktop environment.

The Fedora mailing list is full of the proposals for system-wide changes in the forthcoming release. All new Fedora releases are shipped with the latest GNOME version. Therefore, GNOME 3.24 is debuting on Fedora 26. This desktop environment is scheduled to be published in March 2017.



The new GNOME build comes with numerous features and visual changes. There is an improved control centre with updated user accounts, printer settings panel and online accounts. Also, the desktop environment comes with a provision for a sharing framework and the photo import feature. A new panel to save passwords for key applications is also provided with the latest GNOME.

In addition to the updated GNOME desktop environment, Fedora 26 will offer ownCloud integration within the pre-installed music app. The user interface of the Epiphany Web browser is also due to receive visual changes. Fedora 26 will also have Anaconda LVM RAID implementation to help you create LVM (Logical Volume Management) RAID volumes while installing the OS. Likewise, another proposal suggests the use of KCM (Kerberos credential cache) by default. KCM can be of great use in a containerised environment.

The open source Fedora project is supposed to roll out Fedora 26 on June 6, 2017. It would be the first Fedora version to include OpenSSL 1.1.0 along with new cryptographic algorithms and some major system improvements.

